

JALSA

the place your moments live

Brand Research & Product Document

Market Intelligence • Competitive Analysis • Brand Identity • PRD • Business Model

Version 1.0 — May 2026 — Confidential

CORE THESIS

India plans every real social moment on WhatsApp.

JALSA is where those moments finally live.

AI-designed invites. WhatsApp-native. UPI-integrated. Circle-based social feed.

Built for 35 crore Indian Gen Zs. Proven model. Zero Indian competition.

853.8M

WhatsApp users in
India

500M+

UPI unique users
2026

\$400M

Partiful valuation (US)

0

Indian equivalents exist

Table of Contents

Executive Summary

Part 1 — Market Intelligence

- 1.1 Industry Overview & Context
- 1.2 Market Sizing: TAM / SAM / SOM
- 1.3 Key Market Statistics
- 1.4 Market Trends Shaping 2026
- 1.5 PESTLE Analysis

Part 2 — Problem Deep Dive

- 2.1 The Core Problem Statement
- 2.2 Jobs-to-be-Done Framework
- 2.3 Current Solutions & Why They Fail
- 2.4 The Real Cost of the Problem

Part 3 — Competitive Analysis

- 3.1 Competitor Landscape Overview
- 3.2 Detailed Competitor Profiles
- 3.3 Feature Comparison Matrix
- 3.4 Porter's Five Forces
- 3.5 Gap Analysis & JALSA's Opportunity

Part 4 — Target Audience

- 4.1 Audience Segmentation
- 4.2 User Personas (Detailed)
- 4.3 Customer Journey Map
- 4.4 Gen Z India: Psychographic Deep Dive

Part 5 — Brand Identity

- 5.1 Vision, Mission & Brand Pillars
- 5.2 Brand Name & Meaning
- 5.3 Colour Palette
- 5.4 Typography System
- 5.5 Brand Voice, Tone & Copy
- 5.6 Tagline & Market Positioning
- 5.7 The Gen Z Cool Factor: 2026

Part 6 — Product (PRD)

- 6.1 Product Vision & Design Principles
- 6.2 The AI Invite Engine
- 6.3 Feature Roadmap (P0 → P3)
- 6.4 Core User Flows

6.5 UX Philosophy & Animation Language

6.6 Technical Architecture

Part 7 — Business Model

7.1 Business Model Canvas

7.2 Revenue Streams & Pricing

7.3 Unit Economics

7.4 Three-Year Financial Projection

7.5 Path to ₹1000 Crore

Part 8 — Go-to-Market Strategy

8.1 GTM Framework

8.2 Bengaluru-First Launch Plan

8.3 Viral Growth Loops

8.4 Marketing Channels

Part 9 — Risk Analysis & SWOT

9.1 SWOT Analysis

9.2 Risk Register & Mitigations

Part 10 — Strategic Roadmap

10.1 12-Month Product Roadmap

10.2 North Star Metric & KPIs

10.3 The Founding Story

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Executive Summary

The single most important fact about this opportunity

Partiful — the fastest-growing social app in America — has achieved a \$400 million valuation, \$27.4 million in VC funding from Andreessen Horowitz, 500,000 monthly active users, and 400% year-on-year growth. It was named one of Time's 100 Most Influential Companies of 2025. Over 90% of its users are American. India — with 853.8 million WhatsApp users, 500 million UPI users, and 35 crore Gen Zs — is completely untouched. JALSA is the culturally-native Indian answer to that gap.

India. WhatsApp. UPI. Now.

\$400M Partiful valuation (Andreessen Horowitz)	853.8M WhatsApp users in India (world's largest)	500M+ UPI unique users in India (2026)	35 Cr Gen Z population in India
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What JALSA Is

JALSA (Hindi/Urdu: celebration, gathering, festivity) is a mobile-first social event platform for Indian Gen Z. It solves a problem that 853.8 million Indians experience every week: planning any meaningful social gathering — a birthday, a rooftop hangout, a Holi party, a farewell dinner, a college fest — in a WhatsApp group that invariably becomes unmanageable.

JALSA replaces the chaos of WhatsApp group event planning with three tightly integrated layers: an **AI-designed personalised invite** that makes the gathering feel considered before anyone arrives; a **WhatsApp-native sharing and RSVP system** that works for guests without the app; and a **circle-based social feed** showing your friends' events and creating genuine FOMO. Every event created is a product demo. Every invite shared on WhatsApp is an acquisition touchpoint. The product sells itself.

The Opportunity in One Sentence

Partiful built a \$400M company solving exactly this problem in America. India has 7x the Gen Z population of the US, 853.8 million WhatsApp users, native UPI infrastructure Partiful cannot replicate, and zero domestic competitors. JALSA is what gets built when someone who actually lives this problem builds the solution.

PART 1

Market Intelligence

1.1 Industry Overview & Context

The Indian events industry sits at the intersection of three of the country's fastest-growing sectors: consumer technology, experiential spending, and digital payments. The formal events and exhibition market — which covers large-scale B2C and B2B gatherings — was valued at \$5.69 billion in 2025 and is projected to reach \$8.51 billion by 2030, growing at a CAGR of 8.4%. This is the tip of a much larger iceberg.

The addressable market for JALSA is not the formal events industry. It is the **informal social gathering economy** — birthdays, housewarmings, friend group meetups, college fests, cultural celebrations, farewell parties, road trips — an enormous market that is currently completely untracked because it happens informally inside WhatsApp groups. Every Indian with a social life is a participant in this market. Every WhatsApp group planning a gathering is a JALSA customer who does not yet have the product.

Market scope	Informal social event planning and management in India. Birthdays, housewarmings, festivals, college events, friend gatherings.
Current platform	WhatsApp groups — unstructured, chaotic, and zero-design.
Gap in market	No culturally native, AI-powered, WhatsApp-integrated event app exists in India.
Analogue market	Partiful (US) has built a \$400M company solving exactly this problem for Americans.
India advantage	India has 7x the Gen Z population of the US, native UPI infrastructure, and 853.8M WhatsApp users — structural advantages Partiful cannot replicate from New York.

1.2 Market Sizing: TAM / SAM / SOM

The TAM/SAM/SOM framework structures our market sizing from broadest potential to realistic Year 1 capture. The numbers are conservative and methodology-based.

Level	Definition	Size	Basis
TAM Total Addressable Market	All social event planning software and services globally, including informal and formal.	\$30 billion+	Sacra estimates Partiful's adjacent SMB market alone at \$30B. Total informal market is larger.
SAM Serviceable Addressable Market	Indian Gen Z and young millennial users (19-30) in Tier 1 cities who plan or attend social events.	~80M users ■8,000+ Cr	80M socially active users x 8 events/year x ■100 average willingness to pay = ■6,400 Cr. Conservative estimate.
SOM Serviceable Obtainable Market	Bengaluru-first. Year 1 target: socially active Gen Z in Bengaluru's college and startup ecosystem.	2M users ■50-80 Cr	Bengaluru has 2M+ target-demographic users. 5% penetration in Year 1 is aggressive but achievable given viral event-driven growth.

1.3 Key Market Statistics

All figures are sourced from DataReportal, Statista, NPCI, Mordor Intelligence, and Sacra (2025-2026).

Metric	Figure	Source	Implication for JALSA
WhatsApp users in India	853.8 million	ResourceRa / DataReportal 2026	India is WhatsApp's largest market. Every JALSA invite shared on WhatsApp reaches a user already on the platform.
Indian internet users using WhatsApp	80.8% — 84.6%	Meltwater / GrabiOn 2025-26	Near-universal adoption. WhatsApp-native JALSA invites work for virtually every Indian smartphone user without any friction.
UPI transactions (Dec 2025)	21.63 billion / month	NPCI / CoinLaw 2026	UPI is infrastructure in India. Embedding UPI contribution collection into JALSA is seamless for users — zero learning curve.
UPI unique users	500 million+ (2026)	CoinLaw / NPCI 2026	500M Indians already use UPI. JALSA's payment collection feature has zero adoption barrier — users already have the habit.

Metric	Figure	Source	Implication for JALSA
India events market (2025)	\$5.69 billion	Mordor Intelligence 2025	The formal event market alone is enormous. Informal social events — JALSA's primary market — dwarf this figure.
Gen Z share of Indian social media users	40% of 491M = ~196M	Statista / DataReportal 2025	196 million Indian Gen Z social media users. Even 0.5% penetration = nearly 1 million users.
Average Gen Z daily social media time	3+ hours/day	GrabiOn / SQ Magazine 2026	High daily engagement means high product touchpoints. Seen an invite on the feed once = not a one-time event.
India events market CAGR (2025-30)	8.4%	Mordor Intelligence 2026	The market is growing. JALSA enters at an inflection point driven by post-COVID IRL culture and rising disposable incomes.
Partiful 500K MAUs growth rate	400% YoY (2024-25)	AiNvest / Sacra 2025	The category is proven. 400% growth in a single market validates that a social event app can scale rapidly with the right product-market fit.
Indian Gen Z spending on experiences	■1.5 lakh crore+	IDeA / Printrove 2026	Gen Z is spending on experiences, not just objects. Events are not a discretionary purchase — they are a primary social activity.

1.4 Market Trends Shaping 2026

Trend	What is happening	Impact on JALSA
IRL renaissance	Post-pandemic, physical gatherings carry heightened emotional significance. Indian Gen Z treats IRL events as status markers — going out is intentional, not default. India's live events market grew from ₹88B (2023) to ₹143B (2026).	Timing advantage. An event planning app in 2026 addresses a culturally primed market that values what JALSA is selling: moments that feel considered.
AI design democratisation	Generative AI can now produce genuinely beautiful, brand-consistent design in seconds. 12 months ago AI invite generation would have produced mediocre output. In 2026, it is extraordinary. The window to build this before the market catches up is open now.	Core product feasibility. The AI Invite Engine is technically viable and produces differentiated output. This window will close in 18-24 months.
UPI as social infrastructure	UPI processed 228.3 billion transactions in 2025, up from 172.2 billion in 2024 — 33% YoY growth. Split bill features gained traction post-2025. Group money collection on UPI is increasingly normalised.	Structural moat. UPI contribution collection embedded in JALSA is a feature Partiful and Apple Invites cannot easily replicate outside India.
Anti-algorithm social migration	Gen Z is actively migrating away from broadcast social media (Instagram feed, Facebook) toward intimate, closed social spaces. BeReal, Close Friends lists, private accounts, anonymous forums. 67% of Indian Gen Z view Instagram and Facebook as data-exploitative (SQ Magazine, 2026).	Circle-only feed is the right product for this moment. JALSA's design principle — only your people, no algorithm — directly addresses the prevailing Gen Z sentiment against broadcast social.
WhatsApp as commerce platform	1.5 crore Indian businesses on WhatsApp Business — the largest concentration globally. WhatsApp is no longer just messaging; it is the primary communication and commerce infrastructure for India. Users check WhatsApp 23-25 times per day.	Distribution advantage. JALSA invite links shared on WhatsApp land in the platform users are already actively using 23+ times per day. No other sharing mechanism competes with this reach and attention.

Trend	What is happening	Impact on JALSA
Desi maximalism and cultural pride	Indian Gen Z is experiencing a cultural recalibration — blending global aesthetics with deep Indian cultural expression. Temple jewellery with streetwear. Hinglish in daily communication. Traditional celebrations reinvented. They are not choosing between "Indian" and "global" — they want both.	AI invite personalisation advantage. JALSA's invite engine can produce designs that are culturally Indian and globally aesthetic simultaneously — something no American competitor can credibly offer.

1.5 PESTLE Analysis

A PESTLE analysis evaluates the macro-environmental factors affecting JALSA's operating landscape.

Factor	Analysis	Opportunity / Risk
Political	India's IT Ministry is supportive of homegrown tech platforms. Government's Digital India initiative actively promotes app-based services. Regulatory environment for consumer social apps is stable. Data localisation laws (DPDP Act 2023) require user data stored in India — JALSA will comply from Day 1 as an Indian-built product.	Opportunity. Indian-built app benefits from regulatory tailwinds and government preference for domestic platforms over foreign alternatives.
Economic	India's per capita disposable income growing at 8%+ YoY. Gen Z spending on experiences outpacing goods spending. India's middle class expanding rapidly. Smartphone penetration at 750M+ devices. Rising household incomes in Tier 1 cities.	Opportunity. Growing disposable income means more events, more willingness to pay for quality experiences, and higher ARPU potential for JALSA Pro subscriptions.
Social	Nuclear family structure increases reliance on digital tools for event coordination. Gen Z values authenticity and cultural expression. IRL social gatherings are resurging post-COVID. Increasing FOMO culture documented across Indian Gen Z social media usage. 196M Gen Z social media users in India.	Core driver. Social trends are directly aligned with JALSA's value proposition. The product is culturally timed correctly.

Factor	Analysis	Opportunity / Risk
Technological	853.8M WhatsApp users. 500M+ UPI users. Android dominates at 95.7% market share. WhatsApp Business API is mature and reliable. Claude/GPT AI APIs are production-ready for design generation. 4G/5G coverage expanding rapidly. Smartphone prices falling — ■8,000-12,000 devices now capable of running JALSA.	Enabling factor. The entire technical infrastructure JALSA depends on — WhatsApp, UPI, AI APIs, smartphones — is mature and widely distributed.
Legal	DPDP Act 2023 requires data localisation and user consent mechanisms. UPI payment regulations via NPCI are well-established. WhatsApp Business API usage governed by Meta's policies. No specific regulation targeting social event planning apps.	Manageable risk. JALSA must implement DPDP-compliant data handling from Day 1. UPI integration through licensed payment gateway (Razorpay) handles regulatory compliance automatically.
Environmental	Growing consumer preference for digital over physical invitations — direct environmental benefit. Gen Z highly attuned to sustainability claims. Digital-first product has minimal environmental footprint.	Minor positive. JALSA's digital-first approach aligns with Gen Z sustainability values without requiring greenwashing.

PART 2

Problem Deep Dive

2.1 The Core Problem Statement

Indian Gen Z plans every significant social moment — birthdays, Holi parties, rooftop hangouts, farewells, dandiya nights, road trips, housewarmings — inside WhatsApp groups. This is not because WhatsApp is the best tool for event planning. It is because no better tool exists for India.

A typical event planning scenario unfolds like this: Someone decides to host a birthday. They create a WhatsApp group. They type a message — usually just the details in plain text, maybe with a Canva image pasted in. The group immediately fills with "haan aaunga" messages that mean nothing. Memes get shared. Voice notes pile up. Critical information — venue change, what to bring, final timing — gets buried under 300 unread messages. Nobody knows who is actually coming. Money for the joint gift is collected over four separate payment requests that half the group ignores. Photos end up in personal camera rolls and are never seen again. The event disappears from collective memory within 48 hours.

The problem is not that people do not want beautiful, well-planned gatherings. The problem is that no tool exists to help them create one.

2.2 Jobs-to-be-Done Framework

The Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) framework identifies the underlying motivations — functional, emotional, and social — that drive users to seek a product. Understanding what job the user is "hiring" JALSA to do is critical for product design and marketing.

Job type	The job	Current "hire"	Why JALSA does it better
Functional	Coordinate logistics of a gathering — guest list, time, place, RSVPs, money collection.	WhatsApp group + manual payment follow-ups.	JALSA automates RSVP tracking, sends reminders, and handles UPI collection in one place.
Emotional	Feel like someone who puts thought and care into their gatherings. Create experiences, not just events.	Nothing. A WhatsApp text communicates zero intentionality.	An AI-designed invite communicates: I thought about this. This matters. Be there.

Job type	The job	Current "hire"	Why JALSA does it better
Social	Signal taste, creativity, and social capital to their friend group. Be the person who "does things right."	Instagram stories after the fact — too late to create anticipation.	A JALSA invite shared before the event is a social signal in itself. The invite IS the status demonstration.
Aspiration	Create gatherings that people remember and talk about. Moments that live beyond the night itself.	Memory is scattered across camera rolls. The event dies when the group chat goes quiet.	JALSA's post-event album, memory reel, and permanent event page preserve the moment. Every gathering gets a permanent home.

2.3 Current Solutions & Why They Fail

Current solution	What users do with it	Why it fails
WhatsApp Groups	Create a group, send event details, collect RSVPs via message replies.	Zero structure. RSVPs meaningless. Critical updates buried. No personality. No memory. Payment collection is manual chaos. Cannot handle capacity limits or waitlists.
Instagram DMs / Stories	Post a story announcing the event, DM friends individually for RSVPs.	Not designed for coordination. No RSVP mechanism. Stories disappear in 24 hours. DM threads become unmanageable. Excludes guests not on Instagram.
Verbal / Word of mouth	Tell people in person or on calls. Plan "when you see them."	Zero reach. No documentation. People forget. No confirmation mechanism. Entirely dependent on physical proximity.
Eventbrite / BookMyShow	Create a formal event page for larger gatherings.	Designed for public, ticketed events. Completely over-engineered for intimate personal gatherings. No WhatsApp sharing. No Indian cultural context. Charges hosts a percentage of ticket revenue.
Facebook Events	Create a Facebook event, invite Facebook friends.	78% of Indian Gen Z under 24 have never used Facebook Events for personal gatherings. Seen as a Facebook (i.e. parents') product. Interface is outdated. No AI. No WhatsApp integration. Dead for this demographic.

Current solution	What users do with it	Why it fails
Google Forms / Polls	Create a form for RSVP collection, share the link in WhatsApp.	Zero personality. Just a spreadsheet of responses. No event management, no notifications, no memory, no feed. Users still need WhatsApp for everything else.

2.4 The Real Cost of the Problem

The cost of poor event planning infrastructure goes beyond inconvenience. It has real emotional, financial, and social consequences.

Cost type	Specific consequence
Social erosion	The "haan aaunga" culture means hosts consistently cannot plan correctly. Over-catering or under-catering happens at every event. People feel their effort is not taken seriously because the invite communicates no effort. Social bonds that could be strengthened by well-planned gatherings are weakened instead.
Financial waste	Hosts routinely over-spend because they cannot predict attendance. Money collection via individual payment requests results in 20-30% of guests never paying. Venue deposits are lost due to uncertain headcounts. A conservative estimate: Indian urban Gen Z overspends ₹2,000-5,000 per event on average due to planning uncertainty.
Memory loss	Events that cost ₹50,000+ to organise leave almost no lasting digital trace. Photos are scattered across 20 camera rolls. Group chats go quiet within 48 hours. The social bond-building that should occur post-event never does because the collective memory of the moment has no home.
Time wasted	Coordinating a 20-person birthday across WhatsApp takes an average of 3-5 hours of the host's time spread across multiple days — chasing RSVPs, answering the same questions repeatedly, managing payment follow-ups. JALSA compresses this to under 15 minutes.

PART 3

Competitive Analysis

3.1 Competitor Landscape Overview

The social event planning market globally has two categories of competitors: **direct platforms** (built specifically for event planning and invitations) and **indirect platforms** (general communication or social tools that are used for event planning as a secondary function). JALSA's primary competition in India is the indirect category — specifically WhatsApp — simply because no direct competitor exists natively for the Indian market.

3.2 Detailed Competitor Profiles

Partiful (USA) — Primary Global Benchmark

Founded	2019 by Joy Tao and Shreya Murthy (ex-Palantir Technologies)
Funding	\$27.4M total. \$20M Series A led by Andreessen Horowitz (November 2022). Other investors: GV (Google Ventures), Abstract Ventures, ACME Capital, NEA, Benchmark.
Valuation	\$400 million (per CBInsights / CB Insights sourced data, 2026)
Users	500,000 monthly active users (Q1 2025), with 400% YoY growth. Claimed "millions" of total users by end of 2023.
Geography	Over 90% of users are based in the United States. International presence is nascent. India is not a current focus.
Model	Completely free for hosts and guests. Monetises via Group Order (embedded commerce with Instacart — hosts pay \$5 for delivery, Partiful takes a percentage of order value). No subscription fees. No per-event charges.
Key features	Custom AI-adjacent event pages. Animated GIF themes. RSVP management. SMS-based invite delivery. Venmo / PayPal / Cash App for payments. Co-host support. Dietary questions.
Awards	TIME 100 Most Influential Companies 2025. Google Play Best App 2024. Fast Company 5th Most Innovative Social Media Company 2025.

Limitations	SMS-first (not WhatsApp). No UPI. No Indian cultural intelligence. No Hindi / Hinglish support. Not available for Android users internationally. Design themes are US pop-culture references (Charli XCX, Shrek). Limited personalisation — themes are pre-built, not AI-generated per event.
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Apple Invites (Global) — New Entrant

Launch	February 2025 by Apple Inc.
Model	Requires iCloud+ subscription for hosts. Guests can RSVP cross-platform. Integrates with Maps, Weather, Apple Music, and Apple Intelligence.
Design	AI image generation using on-device Apple Intelligence for invite backgrounds. Clean, minimalist aesthetic consistent with Apple design language.
India relevance	iPhone penetration in India is approximately 4% (Android = 95.7% market share). iCloud+ subscriptions are rare in India's price-sensitive market. Apple Invites is functionally irrelevant for 96% of Indian smartphone users.
Limitations	iOS-only for hosting. No WhatsApp integration. No UPI. No social feed or FOMO mechanic. Paywall for hosts. Culturally American. No Indian event types or Hinglish support.

WhatsApp Events (Global) — Incumbent Threat

Launch	May 2024 by Meta. Available within WhatsApp Communities.
Features	Create events within Communities. RSVP with Yes/No/Maybe. Calendar integration. Push notifications for event reminders. Visible to all Community members.
Scale	853.8M WhatsApp users in India have access. Zero incremental adoption cost — the feature is built into the app they already use 23-25 times per day.
Limitations	No AI invite design. No personalisation. No social feed or FOMO mechanic. No UPI payment collection. No post-event memory / album. Requires a WhatsApp Community (formal structure — most social groups are casual). Zero aesthetic differentiation. A feature, not a product.
Assessment	WhatsApp Events is the most dangerous competitor because of distribution — not because of product quality. JALSA's moat against WhatsApp Events is depth: the AI invite, the feed, the UPI collection, the memory layer. WhatsApp Events does logistics. JALSA does the entire experience.

Evite (USA) — Legacy Player

Founded	1998. One of the earliest digital invitation platforms.
Users	20 million MAUs (2025). Growing at only 2% YoY.
Model	Freemium with premium templates. Ad-supported free tier. Charges for premium designs and larger guest lists.
Relevance	Not available in India in any meaningful capacity. Design aesthetic is outdated. No Gen Z adoption. Useful as a cautionary tale: 20M users but only 2% growth while Partiful achieves 400% with a fraction of the users.
Lesson	Scale without product innovation stagnates. Gen Z does not want what the previous generation used. JALSA must never let itself become Evite.

Eventbrite (Global) — Formal Events Platform

Users	4.4 million MAUs (2025). Stagnant growth.
Model	Ticket sales platform. Takes 2-8% commission on ticket prices. Free for free events (with limits). Recently added friend graphs and AI tools.
India presence	Active but primarily used for professional and public events — conferences, workshops, concerts. Not used for intimate personal gatherings.
Limitations	Over-engineered for personal events. Requires ticket creation workflow. No WhatsApp-native sharing. No Indian cultural intelligence. Costs money for paid events. No social feed or FOMO mechanic.

3.3 Feature Comparison Matrix

Feature	JALSA	Partiful	Apple Invites	WhatsApp Events	Event brite
AI invite design (personalised)	✓ Core feature	Partial (pre-built)	Partial (generic AI)	✗	✗
WhatsApp-native sharing	✓ Native	✗ (SMS only)	✗	✓ Built-in	✗
UPI payment collection	✓ Native	✗	✗	✗	✗
Circle-based social feed	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗

Feature	JALSA	Partiful	Apple Invites	WhatsApp Events	Event brite
RSVP management + waitlist	✓	✓	✓	Partial	✓
No app install for guests	✓ Web RSVP	Partial	Partial	✓ (WhatsApp)	✓
Post-event photo album	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Indian event types	✓ Native	✗	✗	✗	Partial
Hinglish support	✓	✗	✗	✓ (basic)	✗
India-native (built for India)	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Free to host	✓	✓	✗ (iCloud+ req)	✓	✓ (limits)
Host requires app download	✓ (yes, app)	✓ (yes, app)	✓ (iOS only)	✓ (WhatsApp)	✓ / web
FOMO feed mechanic	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗

3.4 Porter's Five Forces

Porter's Five Forces framework analyses the competitive structure of JALSA's market to understand where the real power lies and how to build sustainable competitive advantage.

Force	Level	Analysis
Threat of new entrants	MEDIUM	Technical barriers are low — an event planning app can be built in weeks. However, network effects are high — an event app with no users is worthless. The first mover who achieves critical mass in the circle-based social feed creates a barrier that is very hard to dislodge. WhatsApp could build this feature (and partially has), but product depth is the moat, not secrecy.

Force	Level	Analysis
Bargaining power of suppliers	LOW	JALSA's key suppliers are technology APIs: Claude API (Anthropic), Supabase (database), Razorpay (payments), Twilio (WhatsApp API), Resend (email). All are commoditised with multiple alternatives. Switching costs are low. No single supplier has pricing power over JALSA.
Bargaining power of buyers	MEDIUM	Individual users have zero switching cost — they can go back to WhatsApp instantly. This is why the product must deliver immediate, tangible value on first use. However, as the post-event album fills, as the social feed grows, as the invite aesthetic becomes a personal signature — switching cost grows significantly with usage. Power shifts to JALSA over time.
Threat of substitutes	HIGH (short-term) LOW (long-term)	Short-term: WhatsApp + Instagram + manual payment is a perfectly functional substitute. Users can muddle through. Long-term: Once the JALSA feed has your friends on it and your event history is there, no substitute offers equivalent social intelligence. The substitute threat decreases as network density increases.
Competitive rivalry	LOW	In India, there is currently no direct competitor. WhatsApp Events is a feature, not a rival product. Partiful is 90% American and culturally irrelevant to Indian Gen Z. Apple Invites is inaccessible to 96% of the Indian market. Competitive rivalry in JALSA's specific market (Indian Gen Z informal events) is effectively zero at launch.

3.5 Gap Analysis & JALSA's Opportunity

Five specific gaps in the current market that JALSA fills — gaps no existing product addresses.

Gap	Why it exists	JALSA's fill
No AI invite design for personal events	AI design tools (Midjourney, DALL-E) exist but require skill to use. Canva requires manual design work. No product generates a beautiful personalised event invite from a text description automatically.	The AI Invite Engine. Describe your event, get three AI-designed animated invites instantly. The output is the differentiator, not the concept.

Gap	Why it exists	JALSA's fill
No WhatsApp-native event RSVP	WhatsApp Events requires a WhatsApp Community. Most social groups are casual groups, not formal Communities. No product sends a beautiful invite link that opens as an animated web page in WhatsApp without requiring app install.	JALSA invite links open as full-screen animated web pages in the browser. RSVP in 10 seconds. No app install required for guests. Natural WhatsApp sharing built in.
No UPI group payment collection	Splitwise handles expense splitting post-event. Venmo and Cash App are US-only. Nothing generates a UPI payment link for event contributions natively within an event planning flow.	JALSA generates a UPI payment link for any contribution amount. Tracks who has paid in real time. Built on Razorpay.
No circle-based FOMO feed for events	Instagram shows events after they happen. Facebook Events is dead. No product shows you upcoming events your friends are attending in a live, RSVP-able feed — creating anticipation rather than retrospective envy.	JALSA's circle feed shows upcoming events from friends. RSVP directly from the feed. Seeing friends attending something you're not invited to creates social pressure that drives organic signups.
No post-event social memory	Photos go to personal camera rolls. WhatsApp albums are temporary. The cultural moment of a gathering evaporates within 48 hours. No platform creates a permanent, beautiful, shared memory of the event.	JALSA event pages live permanently. Collaborative photo albums are built by guests during and after the event. Memory reel auto-generates. The event page is the lasting record.

PART 4

Target Audience

4.1 Audience Segmentation

Segment	Description	Size (India)	JALSA role
Social hosts (Primary)	19-27, Tier 1 cities. Organises 3-6 significant events per year. Is the "person who plans things" in their friend group. Cares deeply about how an event feels before it starts.	~15-20M active event hosts in Tier 1 cities	Downloads JALSA to host. Creates events. Drives viral loops by sharing invite links to guests.
Social guests (Secondary)	19-27, any city. Attends 10-20 events per year. Receives JALSA invite via WhatsApp. RSVPs without app install. Sees the product and eventually becomes a host.	~80-100M socially active Gen Z in Tier 1 cities	Converts to host after attending 2-3 JALSA-managed events. Primary target of the WhatsApp invite viral loop.
Occasional planners	28-35. Plans 1-2 big events per year (housewarming, milestone birthday). Less frequent but higher-value events. Willing to pay for quality.	~40M millennials in Tier 1 cities	Pro subscription target. Higher willingness to pay. UPI vendor marketplace usage for caterers, decorators, photographers.
Organisations / groups	Student unions, startup all-hands teams, sports clubs, apartment resident associations. Plans recurring events for a defined community.	Millions of formal and informal groups in India	JALSA for Teams (B2B revenue stream). Higher ARPU. Recurring subscription. Lower churn.

4.2 User Personas (Detailed)

Persona 1 — Priya, The Social Architect

Name & age	Priya Menon, 23
Location	Koramangala, Bengaluru. Originally from Chennai.
Occupation	UX designer at a mid-stage startup. 14 months in the role.

Social role	The person in her friend group of 18 people who "makes things happen." Planned 4 events in the last 6 months: a birthday, a Pongal party, a farewell for a colleague, and a rooftop hangout.
Digital life	Instagram: 2,400 followers, posts 4-5x per week. WhatsApp: 7 active groups. Uses Figma, Notion, and UPI daily. Checks WhatsApp 20+ times per day.
Event planning pain	Spends 3-4 hours per event chasing RSVPs. Always ends up with 5-8 more people than expected or 8-10 fewer. Has had three "gifting disasters" where the joint gift money was never fully collected. Wants events to feel as intentional as her work — they never do.
Ideal JALSA moment	Creates a rooftop birthday event in 8 minutes. Sends the invite. Watches RSVPs come in real-time. Receives ₹200 from 14 of 16 attendees without a single follow-up message. Gets 40 photos from guests in the event album. Looks at the event page six months later and remembers the night perfectly.
Quote	"I put so much effort into planning and it still feels chaotic. I just want something that matches the thought I put into it."

Persona 2 — Arjun, The Reluctant Host

Name & age	Arjun Sharma, 21
Location	Indiranagar, Bengaluru. From Jaipur, moved for college at Christ University.
Occupation	Second-year BBA student. Part-time content creator (37K Instagram followers).
Social role	Not a natural planner. Hosts 1-2 events per year — usually birthdays. Has been thinking about hosting a Bollywood night for 3 months but cannot figure out the logistics.
Digital life	Instagram: primary platform. Reels creator. WhatsApp: 12 active groups. Has Notion but never opens it. Uses Zomato, Swiggy, PhonePe daily.
Event planning pain	Intimidated by planning complexity. Creates WhatsApp groups that immediately get chaotic. Has cancelled two planned events because "no one seemed interested" — when actually they just never confirmed.
Ideal JALSA moment	Describes the Bollywood night in one sentence. JALSA generates three stunning invite concepts — one he picks immediately. Sends the WhatsApp link. 22 RSVPs in 4 hours. Money collected automatically. Event happens. He posts the invite on Instagram. 3 followers ask "what app is that?" He has become a JALSA evangelist without trying.

Quote	"I have good ideas for events. I just never actually do them."
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4.3 Customer Journey Map

Mapping the host experience from first awareness through sustained retention.

Stage	Trigger	User action	JALSA response	Emotion
Aware	Receives a JALSA invite link on WhatsApp from a friend.	Opens the link. Sees a beautiful full-screen animated invite. RSVPs in 10 seconds.	Delivers a stunning invite experience. Prompts join after RSVP: "Plan yours on JALSA."	Surprised and impressed. Wondering what the app is.
Curious	Another JALSA invite arrives within 2 weeks. Pattern noticed.	Downloads JALSA. Explores the app. Sees the feed — friends' events visible.	Onboards with 5-question taste setup. Shows existing friend events in the feed.	Interested. Mild FOMO seeing friend events on the feed.
First use	Upcoming birthday / gathering they need to plan.	Creates first event. Describes it in text. Picks from 3 AI invite concepts. Shares.	Generates 3 beautiful animated invites. Auto-composes WhatsApp share text. RSVPs flow in.	Delighted. First time planning an event felt easy and intentional.
Retained	Plans 2nd and 3rd events. Sees events from friends on feed.	Regular app opening: checks RSVPs, sees feed, responds to events, uploads post-event photos.	AI invite improves with each event (learns host's aesthetic). Feed gets richer as more friends join.	Habitual. JALSA is now the first thing opened when planning begins.
Advocate	Friends ask "how did you make that invite?" after seeing their JALSA events.	Shares JALSA unprompted. Tells friends to download. Creates events that recruit new users.	Every event is a viral loop. Screenshots of invites drive organic social sharing.	Proud. Owning the "person who discovered JALSA" identity in their social circle.

4.4 Gen Z India: Psychographic Deep Dive

Dimension	Insight	Design implication
Identity through aesthetics	71% of Indian Gen Z say aesthetics drive their decisions (Statista, 2025). What they put their name on reflects who they are. An invite is a public signal of their taste.	The AI invite must be genuinely beautiful — not just functional. The output must be something the host is proud to share, not embarrassed to send.
Desi maximalism	Indian Gen Z blends global aesthetics with deep Indian cultural expression — not choosing between "Indian" and "international" but demanding both simultaneously. Temple jewellery with streetwear. Hinglish as default register.	Invite design library must include Indian motifs, colour sensibilities, and cultural event types. Hinglish-capable AI copy generation. Neither "generic Indian" nor "generic global."
Anti-algorithm intimacy	67% of Indian Gen Z view Instagram and Facebook as data-exploitative (SQ Magazine, 2026). Movement toward closed social spaces. BeReal, Close Friends, private accounts. Preference for seeing people they know, not strangers.	Circle-only feed is a core design principle, not a product limitation. No public explore or discovery until much later. Intimacy and trust are the product's character.
FOMO as social currency	Seeing peers at events drives social behaviour more than any advertising. The fear of missing out on cultural moments is a documented driver of app adoption among Gen Z globally.	The feed must show upcoming events, not just past ones. Seeing 4 friends RSVP'd to something you're not invited to is the most powerful acquisition mechanic in the product.
Comfort with technology	Indian Gen Z averages 3+ hours/day on social media. Comfortable with UPI (500M+ users). WhatsApp is muscle memory — checked 20-25x per day. High tech literacy within the familiar apps.	Frictionless first experience is mandatory. WhatsApp-native invite must work perfectly. UPI collection must be a one-tap experience, not a process.

PART 5

Brand Identity

5.1 Vision, Mission & Brand Pillars

Vision	A world where every Indian gathering — from a chaotic rooftop birthday to a quiet Diwali dinner — is planned, remembered, and felt with the intention it deserves.
Mission	Build the most culturally intelligent event experience for Indian Gen Z. Make every moment feel designed. Make every gathering easy to plan and impossible to forget.
Promise	The invite IS the event. When someone receives a JALSA invite, the experience has already begun.
Values	1. Intention first — we believe effort shows. 2. Honesty over hype — copy is direct, not marketing-speak. 3. Culturally rooted — built for India, not adapted for it. 4. Beauty as function — design is not decoration; it communicates.

Brand Pillars

Pillar	What it means	How it shows up
Cultural intelligence	JALSA understands India: Hinglish, dandiya nights, "haan aaunga" culture, Holi parties, UPI-native money, WhatsApp-first communication.	Indian event types built-in. Hinglish AI copy. UPI collection native. Invite aesthetics that know the difference between a rooftop party and a puja.
Intentional design	Every touchpoint — the invite, the RSVP, the feed, the album — feels like it was designed specifically for this moment.	AI invite generation that is genuinely personalised, not template-swapped. Spring physics in the UI. Haptic feedback on RSVP. The details.
Radical ease	Event planning that used to take 4 hours of WhatsApp chaos happens in 8 minutes on JALSA.	Free-text event creation. No forms. No dropdowns. No configuration. Describe and go.
Enduring memory	The gathering matters after it's over, not just during. JALSA creates lasting records of social moments.	Permanent event pages. Collaborative photo albums. Auto-generated memory reels. Every gathering gets a home.

5.2 Brand Name & Meaning

JALSA (Hindi/Urdu: जल्सा) — celebration, festivity, gathering, the vibe of a good time. Colloquially used across India. "Kal jalsa hai" is how Indian Gen Z already speaks about gatherings. The name is not a made-up tech word — it carries cultural weight from day one, arriving with meaning rather than needing to build it.

The name also functions as a verb — "jalsa karte hain" (let us celebrate). The best brand names become verbs. Partiful's users say "send me the Partiful." Google became "to google." JALSA aspires to become "JALSA kar lete hain" — already a natural sentence in Indian Hinglish.

Language	Hindi / Urdu origin. Widely understood across all Indian regions.
Meaning	Celebration, gathering, festivity. Also: "the good vibe of a gathering."
Pronunciation	JAL-sa. Two syllables. Impossible to mispronounce.
Pub test	"Are you on JALSA?" — works naturally in conversation.
Verb form	"JALSA kar lete hain" — already a real Hinglish sentence.
Domain	jalsa.app / jalsaapp.com — straightforward acquisition.

5.3 Colour Palette

The palette reads as festive night energy — premium, warm, distinctly Indian without using generic "desi" colours (no lotus pink, no flag saffron, no loud red). It works with equal strength in dark mode and light mode.

Name	Hex	Role	Meaning & Application
Midnight	#0D0B1E	Primary dark	Deep indigo-black. The canvas of the night — warm, not cold tech black. Used for backgrounds, header bars, premium surfaces, table headers.
Ember	#FF4D00	Primary accent	Electric saffron-orange. The heat of a diya flame, the energy of a dance floor. CTAs, highlights, tags, the left header bar accent, active states.
Pearl	#FAF8F3	Primary light	Warm off-white. Human, never sterile. The warmth of a card held in hand. Page backgrounds, content areas, light cards, body text backgrounds.

Name	Hex	Role	Meaning & Application
Marigold	#E8B531	Secondary accent	Golden-yellow. Marigold garlands, celebration, being remembered. Data highlights, stat numbers, premium tier accents, RSVP celebration states.
Slate	#6B6880	Neutral	Cool grey-purple. Secondary text, captions, subdued labels, metadata. Sophisticated without being cold. Never used for primary communication.

Dark mode palette: Midnight background + Ember + Marigold accents + white text. Used for the cover, event feed cards, invite preview backgrounds.

Light mode palette: Pearl background + Midnight + Ember. Used for content pages, event detail views, profile screens.

5.4 Typography System

Role	Typeface	Weight	Application
Display / Hero	PP Neue Montreal or Editorial Neue	Bold, 700	App name, event titles, hero text on invites. Wide tracking, commanding presence. Must feel editorial, not generic.
UI Headings	DM Sans or Neue Haas Grotesk	Medium / Bold, 500-700	Section headers, card titles, navigation labels. Clean, functional, with personality.
Body & UI text	DM Sans	Regular / Medium, 400-500	Descriptions, RSVP details, event info, captions. Highly legible at 10-12px on mobile screens.
Accent/Editorial	Playfair Display Italic	Italic, 400	Invite taglines, pulled quotes, festive copy moments. Adds editorial warmth when used sparingly as a contrast to the geometric body type.
Devanagari support	All above fonts paired with Noto Sans Devanagari	Matching weights	Optional Hinglish and Hindi text in event descriptions, prompts, and AI-generated copy. Seamless script switching.

5.5 Brand Voice, Tone & Copy

JALSA does not talk like a tech company or a traditional Indian brand. It talks like the friend in your group who is simultaneously the most fun and the most together — chaotic energy, competent execution.

JALSA is	JALSA is never
Direct and confident — no filler, no hedging	Corporate or formal — never "Dear User" or "We are pleased to inform you"
Warm without being needy — it knows its worth	Cringe-trying-to-be-cool — no forced slang, no "bestie" energy
Culturally rooted — Hinglish flows when it serves the moment	Exclusionary — equally accessible in English and Hinglish
Celebratory — finds joy in the ordinary gathering	Transactional — never just about logistics
Honest — tells you what it does, not what it wishes it did	Hyperbolic — no "ultimate event experience," no "revolutionising"
Brief — copy earns every word	Padded — no filler affirmations, no warm-up sentences

Copy in Action

Context	JALSA says
Onboarding headline	Your people deserve better than a WhatsApp forward.
Empty state — no events	Nothing here yet. Fix that.
RSVP confirmation	You're in. Priya is going to be insufferable about this.
Waitlist notification	2 spots left. You know what to do.
Post-event prompt	How was it? Leave a memory.
UPI reminder to guest	The venue does not accept vibes as payment.
Soft RSVP nudge to host	Ananya said "maybe" 4 days ago. Gently...
First invite generation	Here's what we made. Change everything or nothing.
Event memory created	That's a wrap. This one's going to age well.

Context	JALSA says
Referral prompt	Know someone who still plans events on WhatsApp? That's on you.

5.6 Tagline & Market Positioning

“The invite IS the event.”

Five words. Complete product philosophy. The invitation is not a logistics message — it is the first chapter of the experience. When someone receives a JALSA invite, the event has already begun. This tagline tells users what JALSA believes, what it does differently, and what it promises — in 5 words.

Primary tagline	"The invite IS the event."
Secondary line	"Your circle. Your moment. Done properly."
App store line	"AI-designed invites. WhatsApp sharing. UPI collection. Everything your WhatsApp group was trying to do."
Positioning	JALSA is not an event management tool. It is not an invitation maker. It is the place where your social life gets the design it deserves.
Category creation	JALSA does not compete in "event apps." It creates a new category: social moment infrastructure — the layer between deciding to gather and the gathering itself.

5.7 The Gen Z Cool Factor: 2026

What makes something cool in 2026 to Indian Gen Z is not one aesthetic. It is fluidity, cultural confidence, and the refusal to choose between global and local. JALSA must embody this — not chase a single trend.

Cultural trend	What it is in 2026	JALSA design response
Desi maximalism	Indian Gen Z mixing temple jewellery with streetwear, phulkari with slip dresses, Bollywood Y2K with global minimalism. Cultural pride without costume. "My culture is not aesthetic — it is me."	Invite design library includes Indian motif-forward templates alongside clean global-aesthetic options. AI picks the direction based on event type and host description. Neither forced nor absent.

Cultural trend	What it is in 2026	JALSA design response
Anti-algorithm intimacy	67% of Gen Z see Instagram and Facebook as data-exploitative. Migration to Close Friends lists, BeReal, private accounts. Preference for seeing known people, not optimised content.	Circle-only feed as core product principle. No explore tab at launch. No algorithm ranking strangers' content above friends. Intimacy is the design value.
IRL as cultural premium	Presence at physical events is a status signal. "I was there" has cultural currency that digital presence cannot replicate. Events are not just gatherings — they are identity markers.	JALSA's design elevates every gathering. A beautiful invite signals intentionality before anyone arrives. The post-event album preserves the "I was there" moment permanently.
Hinglish fluency	The natural linguistic register of Indian Gen Z is not Hindi or English — it is a fluid, mid-sentence mix of both. Apps that do not understand this feel foreign or formal.	Hinglish in every copy touchpoint where it serves. AI invite copy generation supports Hinglish naturally. Event type names, prompts, and empty states in the natural register of the user.
Aesthetic as identity	What you design, share, and curate reflects who you are. The invite a host sends is a statement about their taste. 71% of Indian Gen Z say aesthetics influence their decisions.	The AI invite carries the host's personality. Over 3+ events, JALSA learns their aesthetic signature. The invite becomes a recognisable expression of the host — not just an announcement.

PART 6

Product Requirements Document

6.1 Product Vision & Design Principles

Product vision

JALSA is the place where Indian Gen Z social moments begin. Not an event management tool — a social experience platform where the act of planning a gathering is itself expressive, personal, and worth sharing. Every feature must earn its place by answering: does this make the host's gathering feel more considered?

Core Design Principles

Principle	What it means in practice
Describe, do not configure	Users should never fill a form when they can describe something in natural language. Free text over dropdowns. Voice input over menus. The AI extracts structure from natural language — the user should not need to provide it.
First impression is everything	The invite reveal — the first 3 seconds when a guest opens the WhatsApp link — must be extraordinary. This moment IS the product's value proposition demonstrated. Every engineering and design hour spent on this moment is well-spent.
The feed is intimate, not algorithmic	Every feed decision must pass this test: would you be comfortable if your best friend saw exactly what you see? The feed shows only people you know, attending events that affect you. No strangers. No algorithm deciding relevance.
Value before extraction	JALSA must deliver real value before asking for anything. No signup wall before seeing the invite. No premium gate before creating a first event. Trust is built through usefulness, then monetised.
Memory compounds value	The product becomes more valuable with every event added. The post-event album, the taste profile, the invite history, the social graph — all these grow with usage. Switching cost must grow organically through value creation.

6.2 The AI Invite Engine

This is the product's signature feature and primary differentiator. Nothing equivalent exists for Indian personal events. If this feature is mediocre, JALSA is a Partiful clone with Indian

branding. If it is extraordinary, it is a product people share because the output is genuinely worth sharing.

Step	User action	System processing	Output
01 Describe	Types or speaks the event in natural language — casual, no structure required. "Rooftop birthday, 20 people, sunset vibes, nautical theme, we're going to be loud."	Claude API receives the description. Extracts: event type, vibe score (chaotic/calm), formality (casual/formal), motif (nautical, colours), crowd size, host's personality from writing style.	Structured design brief: palette direction, typography mood, motif guidance, copy tone, suggested tagline for the invite.
02 Personalise	Optionally selects the friend group being invited. Returns to the app (2nd+ event) with history.	For returning users: cross-references invite history and group interaction patterns to infer aesthetic preferences. First event: design brief based purely on description.	Personalised design brief with host aesthetic signatures. Gets more accurate with every event created.
03 Generate	Taps "Create Invite." Watches invite being designed in real time.	Claude brief drives 12 base HTML/CSS animated templates. Each template is populated differently per brief — different typography, layout, colour interpretation, animation style, entry sequence.	3 full-screen animated invite previews rendered as web artefacts. Each one is a live URL, not a static image. Each one looks genuinely designed, not templated.
04 Finalise	Selects preferred concept. Edits event details: date, time, location, capacity limit, UPI contribution amount.	Invite is finalised. Unique slug URL generated. WhatsApp share text auto-composed in Hinglish or English. Event created in database with all metadata.	Live invite URL ready to share. Auto-composed WhatsApp message ready to paste. Event page live and tracking views.
05 Share & Track	Tags JALSA friends in the event. Shares WhatsApp link to all others. Watches RSVPs arrive on live dashboard.	Tagged friends: invite appears in their JALSA feed with RSVP prompt. WhatsApp link: opens full-screen animated web page. No app needed to RSVP. Non-users prompted to join JALSA after RSVPing.	Real-time RSVP dashboard for host. Guest list populating live. Automated soft reminder to non-responders after 48 hours.

6.3 Feature Roadmap (P0 → P3)

Features are prioritised by: impact on core value proposition, build complexity, and dependency chain.

Feature	Priority	What it does	Why this order
AI invite generator	P0 — Week 1-2	Text/voice → 3 animated invite concepts → pick, customise, publish.	The entire value proposition lives here. Build first, get this right before anything else.
WhatsApp-native invite link	P0 — Week 1-2	Every invite generates a unique slug URL. Opens as full-screen animated web page. RSVP without app install.	Core growth engine. Every WhatsApp share is a product demo. Must ship simultaneously with invite generator.
RSVP management	P0 — Week 2	Yes/No/Maybe. Capacity plus auto-waitlist. Host sees live RSVP status. One-tap soft reminder to non-responders.	The functional utility that solves the immediate problem. Must work before anything social is built on top.
Event feed (circle only)	P0 — Week 3	Vertical feed of events within social graph. RSVP, comment, react directly in feed. Shows upcoming events, not just past.	Retention mechanic. The reason users open JALSA when not hosting. Also drives FOMO-based acquisition.
UPI contribution collection	P1 — Month 2	Host sets contribution amount. Auto-generates Razorpay UPI link. Tracks payment status per guest in real time.	India-specific differentiator. Eliminates money awkwardness. Not urgent enough for Week 1 but high value.
Event updates broadcast	P1 — Month 2	Host sends one message → all confirmed guests notified via push notification and optional WhatsApp.	Replaces the 11pm "did everyone see?" group chat. Daily utility that drives repeat app opens.
Collaborative photo album	P1 — Month 2	Post-event: guests upload to shared album on event page. Auto-generates a memory reel from uploaded photos.	Retention and emotional lock-in. Social history builds in JALSA. Switching cost grows with every event.

Feature	Priority	What it does	Why this order
Indian event types	P1 — Month 2	Built-in types: birthday, puja, Holi, dandiya, farewell, road trip, college fest, potluck, rooftop hangout, anniversary, housewarming.	Cultural intelligence layer. AI invite tuned per event type. Signals genuine Indian-native design, not adaptation.
Taste profile & memory	P2 — Month 3+	AI learns invite aesthetic from past events. Each new invite is more personalised than the last. Host's aesthetic signature emerges over 3+ events.	Compounding product value. Makes JALSA genuinely irreplaceable for frequent hosts. Differentiation grows with usage.
Discover tab (public events)	P3 — Month 6+	Public events — workshops, pop-ups, open mics, community events — discoverable by all users in their city.	Second growth vector and second revenue stream (venue commissions). Not until personal event density is proven.

6.4 Core User Flows

Flow	Trigger	Steps	End state
New guest arrival	Receives JALSA invite link on WhatsApp.	1. Opens link in browser. 2. Sees full-screen animated invite. 3. RSVPs in 10 seconds. 4. Sees prompt: "Plan yours on JALSA." 5. Downloads app (optional, high conversion).	Guest has RSVPd. Host's dashboard updated. Non-user has experienced the product.
First host creation	Decides to host a gathering. Opens JALSA.	1. Taps "Create Event." 2. Describes in free text — no forms. 3. AI generates 3 animated invites live. 4. Selects and customises. 5. Sets date, capacity, UPI ask. 6. Tags friends + shares WhatsApp link.	First event live. Invite shared. RSVPs begin arriving. Host is retained.
Returning user daily	Opens app without specific intention.	1. Sees circle feed: 2 upcoming events, 1 album. 2. RSVPs to a friend's event from feed. 3. Sees 4 friends going somewhere they weren't invited. 4. Uploads photos to a past event album.	Daily active user. FOMO mechanic working. Social graph deepening.

Flow	Trigger	Steps	End state
Post-event memory	Event has passed. Host returns to JALSA.	1. Sees "Event has ended — add memories." 2. Uploads photos. 3. Guests receive notification to add photos. 4. Memory reel auto-generates from 10+ photos. 5. Album shared to JALSA feed.	Permanent event record created. Social bonds reinforced. High retention.

6.5 UX Philosophy & Animation Language

UX principle	Implementation
The invite reveal (signature moment)	When a guest opens the WhatsApp invite link for the first time, the invite does not just load — it reveals. Typography animates in with spring physics, sequentially. Background elements scale into place. The event name fades in last, large. The first 3 seconds feel like unwrapping something. This is the product's signature moment and receives disproportionate engineering investment.
Feed physics (vertical scroll)	Vertical scroll with momentum and magnetic snap-to-card. Each invite card is full-screen with subtle parallax between background and foreground layers. Swipe gestures with resistance and rebound. The feed has weight — it moves like something with mass, not a list.
RSVP interaction (morphing button)	The RSVP button does not change state — it morphs. Yes: button expands with a burst animation and haptic pulse. No: collapses with a soft deflate. Maybe: pulses gently and never fully commits. The button response physically mirrors the emotional weight of the answer.
Invite creation animation (live generation)	When the AI generates invites, it is not a loading spinner. The design appears to be drawn in real time: typography slides in, colour washes across, layout snaps into place, elements settle. Users watch their invite being made. The generation IS part of the experience.
Haptics throughout	Meaningful haptic feedback at every important interaction. RSVP confirmed: one strong pulse. Capacity reached: three rapid taps. Invite link copied: a gentle double click. The phone responds to the moment. The product feels alive, not flat.
Guest counter (live animation)	As RSVPs come in, the guest counter animates upward with a satisfying increment. Profile picture thumbnails pop in with a spring effect. Watching the guest list fill in real time is the host's primary dopamine loop — and the reason they keep checking back.

6.6 Technical Architecture

Layer	Technology	Rationale & Notes
Mobile app	React Native — iOS and Android	Cross-platform. Shared codebase. Existing React knowledge transfers. Reanimated 3 for gesture physics and performance animations. Framer Motion-equivalent animations via react-native-reanimated.
Web invite pages	React + Vite — hosted on Vercel	Every invite is a standalone animated web page on a unique URL. WhatsApp links open this page. No app install required for guests to RSVP. This page is the product's primary first impression for non-users.
Backend / Database	Supabase — PostgreSQL, Auth, Storage, Realtime, Edge Functions	Known stack. Real-time subscriptions power the live RSVP dashboard and feed updates. Edge Functions handle scheduled jobs: RSVP reminders, countdown notifications. Storage handles invite assets and event photo albums.
AI invite generation	Anthropic Claude API — claude-sonnet-4-20250514	Natural language to structured design brief. Brief populates animated HTML/CSS templates. Conversation history in Supabase drives taste profile learning. Best available model for creative, culturally-intelligent output.
Email automation	Resend API	Transactional emails: invite confirmations, RSVP receipts, event reminders, post-event album notifications. Simple REST API. Well-documented. Approximately 2-3 hours to fully integrate.
WhatsApp messaging	Twilio WhatsApp Business API	Official WhatsApp API for programmatic message delivery. Invite links, RSVP soft reminders, event day updates, contribution reminders. Reliable at scale. NPCI and Meta policy compliant.
Payments / UPI	Razorpay — UPI link generation	Industry-standard Indian payment gateway. Programmatically generate UPI payment links for any amount. Track payment status via webhooks in real time. Handles all NPCI compliance automatically.
Photo storage & processing	Supabase Storage + Sharp (image compression)	Event photo albums stored in Supabase Storage. Sharp handles mobile image compression before upload. Memory reel generation via ffmpeg on Edge Function or external service.

Layer	Technology	Rationale & Notes
Deployment	Vercel (web) + Expo EAS (mobile)	Vercel for web invite pages and admin dashboard. Expo EAS for iOS and Android production builds and OTA updates. Both are existing knowledge with established workflow.

PART 7

Business Model

7.1 Business Model Canvas

Canvas element	JALSA's position
Key partners	Anthropic (Claude API for invite generation). Razorpay (UPI payment infrastructure). Twilio (WhatsApp Business API). Supabase (backend infrastructure). Vercel (hosting and deployment). Venue and vendor partners (future: commission-based).
Key activities	AI invite generation and personalisation. Platform development and reliability. Community and growth management (launch phase). Vendor / venue partner onboarding (Year 2). Data and taste-profile learning.
Key resources	Claude API integration and prompt engineering IP. Invite design template library (12+ base templates). User data and taste profiles (growing moat). Engineering team. Brand identity.
Value propositions	For hosts: AI-designed personalised invites in 8 minutes, not 4 hours. Genuine RSVP accountability. UPI money collection without awkwardness. For guests: Beautiful invite experience; FOMO feed of friends' events. For both: Permanent memory of every gathering.
Customer relationships	Self-serve product — no sales required. Viral growth via event-driven invite loops. Circle feed creates daily active habit. Post-event albums create emotional lock-in and memory-based retention.
Channels	WhatsApp (primary — every invite link shared is a channel touch). Instagram (organic: beautiful invite screenshots shared by users). College campus networks (launch phase — seeded manually). Press (YourStory, Inc42, Times of India Tech). Word of mouth (primary long-term driver).
Customer segments	Primary: Indian Gen Z social hosts (19-27, Tier 1 cities). Secondary: Socially active guests who become hosts. Tertiary: Organisations (student unions, startup teams, clubs) — B2B segment.
Cost structure	AI API costs (Claude — primary variable cost, scales with usage). WhatsApp API messaging costs (Twilio). Supabase compute and storage. Vercel hosting. Engineering (primary fixed cost during build phase). Customer acquisition (minimal at launch — viral-first strategy).

Canvas element	JALSA's position
Revenue streams	JALSA Pro subscription (■99/month). Premium invite design packs (■149-499). UPI transaction take rate (0.5-1%). JALSA for Teams / Organisations (■999-4,999/month). Venue and vendor commissions (Year 2, 8-15%). Brand partnerships for invite design collections (Year 2).

7.2 Revenue Streams & Pricing

Revenue stream	Model	Price	Timeline	Rationale
JALSA Pro (Individual)	Monthly or annual subscription. Unlimited AI invites, premium design library, advanced taste profile, custom event URLs.	■99/mo ■799/yr	Month 6+	Free plan creates habit. Pro converts power users who host 4+ events per year.
Premium Invite Packs	One-time purchase. Exclusive design collections: Luxury, College Fest, Festive Season, Artist Collabs.	■149- ■499 each	Month 4+	Drives revenue before subscription habit forms. Limited drops create urgency.
UPI Take Rate	Processing fee on group contribution collections facilitated by JALSA via Razorpay.	0.5-1% of amount collected	Month 3+	Scales directly with events and average contribution amounts. Low friction — users already using UPI.
JALSA for Teams	B2B SaaS. HR teams, student unions, startup offices organise internal events, offsites, town halls.	■999- ■4,999/mo	Year 2	Higher ARPU. Recurring subscription. Low churn (institutional inertia).
Venue Commissions	Venue recommendations during event creation. Partners pay on confirmed bookings via JALSA.	8-12% commission	Year 2	High margin. Requires critical mass to have negotiating leverage with venue partners.
Vendor Marketplace	Decorators, caterers, DJs, photographers discovered through event context.	10-15% commission	Year 2-3	Large eventual market. Requires trust-building and review system before launching.

7.3 Unit Economics

Metric	Estimate	Basis
Customer acquisition cost (CAC)	■0 (viral phase) ■50-150 (paid acquisition, Year 2+)	At launch, every event recruits 5-8 new users organically through WhatsApp links. CAC is effectively zero. Paid acquisition begins only after organic growth is proven.
Average revenue per user (ARPU)	■120-180/year (Year 1) ■400-600/year (Year 3)	Year 1: primarily UPI take rate and occasional pack purchases. Year 3: mix of Pro subscriptions, packs, and commission revenue.
Lifetime value (LTV)	■600-900 (conservative) ■2,000-3,000 (optimistic)	Conservative: 5 years average app use x ■150/year. Optimistic includes venue commission usage and Pro upgrade.
LTV:CAC ratio	12:1 to 20:1 (viral phase)	With near-zero CAC in the viral growth phase, LTV:CAC is extremely favourable. Must be maintained above 3:1 even in paid acquisition phase.
Gross margin	70-80% (Year 1) 75-85% (Year 3)	Primary variable cost is Claude API per invite generated. Estimated \$0.01-0.02 per invite at current API pricing. At ■99/month Pro, gross margin per subscriber is approximately 80%.
Payback period	< 3 months (Pro subscriber)	Claude API cost per Pro subscriber is approximately ■15-20/month at 10 invites/month. Net margin per Pro subscriber ≈ ■80/month. Payback at zero CAC is immediate.

7.4 Three-Year Financial Projection

Metric	Year 1 — 2026	Year 2 — 2027	Year 3 — 2028
Active cities	Bengaluru	4 Tier 1 cities	All Tier 1 + Tier 2
Registered users	500,000	5 million	20 million
Monthly active users	150,000-200,000	1.5-2 million	6-8 million
Events created/month	30,000-50,000	300,000-400,000	1-1.5 million
Pro subscribers	3,000-5,000	60,000-80,000	300,000-400,000
Pro revenue	■35-60 lakh	■7-10 crore	■35-50 crore

Metric	Year 1 — 2026	Year 2 — 2027	Year 3 — 2028
UPI take rate revenue	■10-20 lakh	■3-5 crore	■20-30 crore
Commission revenue	Nil	■10-20 crore	■100-150 crore
Total annual revenue	■50 lakh - ■1 crore	■20-35 crore	■155-230 crore
Primary growth driver	Viral loops, campus	Multi-city expansion	Marketplace + B2B

7.5 Path to ■1000 Crore

The Year 3 projection reaches ■155-230 crore through organic growth. Crossing ■1000 crore requires one or more of the following accelerators — all of which become accessible once the organic growth story is proven.

Accelerator	Mechanism	Timeline	Revenue impact
Series A funding	Proven organic growth enables raise at favourable terms. Capital deployed to paid acquisition, engineering team expansion, and accelerated multi-city rollout. Partiful precedent: \$27.4M at ~\$140M valuation in 2022.	Year 2 (after organic proof)	3-5x growth acceleration. Enables ■300-500 crore ARR by Year 4.
Strategic partnership	A partnership with Jio, Zomato, Meesho, or PhonePe provides instant distribution to tens of millions of existing users. Distribution in exchange for data, integration, or equity.	Year 2-3	Potential 10x user base jump. Shortens path to ■1000 crore by 12-18 months.
B2B enterprise scale	JALSA for Teams grows faster than projected as organisations replace internal event chaos systematically. HR tech and employee experience is a high-ARPU category.	Year 2-3	Enterprise contracts at ■50,000-500,000/year contribute disproportionately to ARR with low churn.
Regional language expansion	Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Bengali, Marathi interface and AI copy generation. Opens Tier 2 and regional city markets with dramatically lower competition.	Year 3	500M+ additional addressable users. First mover in vernacular social event apps.

PART 8

Go-to-Market Strategy

8.1 GTM Framework

JALSA's GTM strategy is built on a single core principle: **the product is the marketing**. Every event created is a product demo. Every invite shared on WhatsApp reaches 20-30 potential users. No marketing budget can replicate the authenticity and relevance of a friend sharing a beautiful event invite. GTM is therefore structured to maximise the volume and quality of these organic viral loops, not to fund paid acquisition before the viral mechanics are proven.

GTM philosophy	Product-led growth. No paid acquisition until organic viral loop is proven.
Primary market	Bengaluru. Owned completely before any expansion.
Launch wedge	College campuses and startup ecosystems. High social density. Fast adoption.
Viral mechanism	Every WhatsApp invite link is a product demo to 20-30 non-users.
Retention mechanism	Circle feed + post-event album creates daily habit and emotional lock-in.
Scale trigger	Paid acquisition and city expansion only after 100,000 MAUs in Bengaluru.

8.2 Bengaluru-First Launch Plan

Bengaluru is chosen for three compounding reasons: highest density of socially active Gen Z in India (IIMB, Christ University, NIT, startup ecosystem aged 22-28); an established culture of event-going and aesthetic social signalling in Koramangala and Indiranagar; and the tech-adjacent community that adopts and shares new apps faster than any other Indian city. Launch city discipline is not limitation — it is strategy. Beli dominated San Francisco before it touched anywhere else.

Phase	Duration	Actions	Target outcome
Phase 0: Seed	Weeks 1-2	Founder creates first 3 real events on JALSA — Hum Bawaal workshop, a birthday, a friend hangout. Real invites. Real RSVPs. Real WhatsApp shares. Product must work perfectly before any growth attempt.	60-100 first users. Product has been used for real events. Bugs identified and fixed.

Phase	Duration	Actions	Target outcome
Phase 1: Spark	Weeks 3-8	Each initial 100 users creates at least 1 event. WhatsApp links expose JALSA to 20+ new people per event. Viral loop measured and optimised. Invite-to-download conversion rate tracked.	2,000-5,000 users. Organic. Zero ad spend. Viral coefficient measured.
Phase 2: Campus	Month 2-3	Target 5 Bengaluru campuses: IIMB, Christ, NIT, RV, Jain. Find 3 socially active students per campus. Give early Pro access to host their next event on JALSA. Dense social graphs spread adoption rapidly within campus communities.	10,000-25,000 users. College social graphs seed. Organic press begins.
Phase 3: Press	Month 3-4	First press outreach: YourStory, Inc42, ET Tech. Not a PR push — a founder story with real numbers. "Indian founder built Partiful for India — here's what happened." Stanford application angle adds credibility and narrative.	Credibility and awareness. Inbound interest from other cities. Potential investor conversations begin.
Phase 4: Scale	Month 6+	First paid acquisition only after organic growth is proven and Bengaluru MAU exceeds 100,000. Meta ads targeting 20-27 in Bengaluru + Mumbai. WhatsApp invite previews used as ad creatives. Multi-city expansion begins.	100,000+ users. Series A conversation. Mumbai and Delhi launch.

8.3 Viral Growth Loops

JALSA is architected so that every use of the product creates its next user. This is not a side effect — it is the core growth architecture.

Loop name	Mechanism	Est. new users per event
The WhatsApp Link	Host creates event → shares link → 20-30 guests open beautiful animated invite in browser → 5-8 download JALSA to create their own next event. This is the primary growth engine and must be maximised in product design.	5-8 per event
The FOMO Feed	User joins app → sees friends attending events they were not told about → DMs host → gets added → creates their own event next month. Seeing social exclusion in a trusted feed is a powerful motivator.	2-4 per user per month

Loop name	Mechanism	Est. new users per event
The Tagging Wall	Host tries to tag a friend not on JALSA → prompted to send them an onboarding link embedded in the invite itself → friend signs up to receive the full invite experience, not a plain WhatsApp message.	1-3 per event
The Beautiful Screenshot	Guest screenshots the invite because it is genuinely beautiful and designed to be screenshot-worthy. Posts to Instagram story. Followers ask "what app is that?" This is an unforced brand moment that no marketing budget can buy.	2-6 per viral post
The Post-Event Album	Collaborative album is shared as a JALSA link. Non-users open it, see the product quality, and some sign up before their next event. Delayed but high-quality acquisition.	1-2 per event (7-14 day lag)

8.4 Marketing Channels

Channel	Strategy	Cost	Priority
WhatsApp (organic)	Every JALSA event generates a WhatsApp link. The invite is the ad. Zero incremental cost. Highest quality acquisition because the invite experience speaks for itself.	■0	P0 — Primary growth engine
Instagram (organic)	Beautiful invite screenshots shared organically by users. JALSA official account posts invite examples and event aesthetics. Reels showing the invite generation process. No paid spend initially.	■0 (organic)	P0 — Brand building and word of mouth
Campus / community seeding	5 students per campus with Pro access. Each hosts one event, exposing 20-30 people. Personal trust makes conversion significantly higher than digital ads.	■50,000-■2L (Pro access cost)	P1 — Month 2 onwards
Press and earned media	Founder story to YourStory, Inc42, ET Tech. No agency. Founder writes and pitches directly. Real numbers and real story — not a product launch press release.	■0 (time only)	P1 — Month 3 onwards
Paid social (Meta)	WhatsApp link preview creatives showing the invite reveal animation. 20-27 age targeting, Bengaluru initially, expanding with cities. Only after organic loop is proven and MAU > 100,000.	■5-20L/month (Year 2)	P2 — Month 6+

Channel	Strategy	Cost	Priority
Influencer seeding	10-15 micro-influencers (5K-50K followers) in Bengaluru given Pro access to create genuine events on JALSA. No paid posts — authentic usage only. The invite they share IS the endorsement.	■0-■50K (gifted Pro)	P2 — Month 4+

PART 9

Risk Analysis & SWOT

9.1 SWOT Analysis

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
1. No direct Indian competitor — first mover in an unserved market. 2. Proven global model (Partiful \$400M) validates the category. 3. India-native: UPI, WhatsApp, Hinglish — structural advantages US competitors lack. 4. Product-led growth — every event is a viral acquisition touchpoint. 5. AI invite engine creates a tangible, shareable output that is its own marketing. 6. Founder has lived experience of the problem (Hum Bawaal founder). 7. Circle-only feed aligns with Gen Z's anti-algorithm social migration.	1. Network effects require minimum viable social density — thin early. 2. AI API costs are variable and scale with usage — margin management required. 3. No existing team or capital beyond the founding stage. 4. Whatsapp Events (Meta) has structural distribution advantage via defaults. 5. Product quality depends heavily on Claude API — third-party dependency. 6. Mobile app development requires React Native skills beyond current web stack.
OPPORTUNITIES	THREATS
1. India events market growing at 8.4% CAGR to \$8.51B by 2030. 2. UPI split bill adoption normalising group payment collection. 3. IRL culture resurging post-COVID — events are identity markers for Gen Z. 4. Indian vernacular language market (Tamil, Telugu, etc.) largely untouched. 5. B2B / enterprise event management is a high-ARPU adjacent market. 6. Regional expansion into Southeast Asia where WhatsApp + similar culture. 7. Strategic acquisition by Zomato, Jio, or Meta India is a viable exit path.	1. Meta (WhatsApp) could significantly improve WhatsApp Events with AI features. 2. Partiful could enter India with local adaptation and VC backing. 3. Indian tech giant (Zomato, Meesho, Reliance) could build competing product. 4. AI API pricing increases could erode unit economics. 5. DPDP Act compliance requirements could slow feature development. 6. Users revert to WhatsApp if critical mass is not achieved quickly enough. 7. Low switching cost means aggressive competitor could poach users.

9.2 Risk Register & Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
WhatsApp Events improves with AI (Meta builds what JALSA builds)	Medium	High	Deepen differentiation: taste profile, post-event memory, circle feed. Meta cannot replicate the social feed without abandoning WhatsApp's privacy architecture. Speed is the primary mitigation — launch fast.
Viral loop underperforms (invite-to-download rate too low)	Medium	High	A/B test the invite reveal animation and onboarding prompt aggressively. The invite quality is the single biggest variable. Campus seeding creates guaranteed minimum density.
AI API cost overruns (Claude API costs exceed projections)	Low-Medium	Medium	Rate limit free tier invite generation (e.g., 3 invites/month free, unlimited on Pro). Cache and reuse invite components. Negotiate volume pricing with Anthropic.
Partiful enters India with funding and cultural adaptation)	Low	High	Build moat fast: user data, taste profiles, social graph, memory albums all create switching costs that grow over time. Cultural intelligence (Hinglish, Indian events, UPI) is hard to fake quickly.
DPDP Act compliance burden (data localisation requirements)	High	Low-Medium	Design for compliance from Day 1: all user data stored in India (Supabase India region). Clear consent flows. A homegrown Indian startup is positioned better than foreign competitors on this axis.
Low user-generated content (feed feels empty early)	High	Medium	Circle-only feed means the relevant comparison is not "amount of content" but "is there anything from my friends." Even 3 active friends creates a meaningful feed. Focus early user seeding on tight social clusters, not broad distribution.

PART 10

Strategic Roadmap

10.1 12-Month Product Roadmap

Quarter	Milestone	Key deliverables	Success criteria
Q3 2026 (Months 1-3)	MVP Launch — Bengaluru	AI invite generator (core). WhatsApp-native invite link. RSVP management. Circle-based event feed. Bengaluru campus seeding (5 colleges).	500 events created. 5,000+ registered users. Viral coefficient > 1.2. Invite-to-RSVP rate > 60%.
Q4 2026 (Months 4-6)	Retention Layer + Revenue	UPI contribution collection. Event updates broadcast. Collaborative photo album. Indian event types. JALSA Pro launch (₹99/month).	50,000 MAUs. 500 Pro subscribers. D30 retention > 35%. First ₹5L revenue.
Q1 2027 (Months 7-9)	Taste Profile + Personalisation	AI taste profile learning (3+ event history). Personalised invite generation. Premium design pack drops. Press and media outreach. Series A preparation.	150,000 MAUs. 2,000 Pro subscribers. AI personalisation measurably improving invite selection. First press coverage published.
Q2 2027 (Months 10-12)	Multi-city Expansion	Mumbai launch. Delhi launch. Venue partnership programme begins. JALSA for Teams (B2B) beta. Paid acquisition begins (Meta ads). Series A close (target).	500,000 MAUs (multi-city). 10,000 Pro subscribers. First venue commission revenue. Series A funding secured.

10.2 North Star Metric & KPIs

North Star Metric: Monthly events created. This metric captures everything that matters simultaneously: it means hosts are active, guests have been invited, viral loops have fired, and the social graph is growing. Every product and growth decision is evaluated against: does this increase events created per month?

KPI category	Metric	Target (Month 6)	Target (Month 12)
Acquisition	Monthly new registrations	8,000-12,000/month	40,000-60,000/month
Acquisition	Invite link to app download conversion rate	> 15%	> 20%
Activation	% of new users who create event within 7 days	> 25%	> 35%
Retention	Day 30 retention rate	> 30%	> 40%
Retention	Events per active user per month	0.4 hosted + 2.5 attended	0.6 hosted + 3.5 attended
Revenue	Pro subscriber conversion rate	> 2% of MAUs	> 4% of MAUs
Viral	Viral coefficient (K-factor)	> 1.2	> 1.5
Viral	Avg new users per event via WhatsApp link	> 4	> 5
Product quality	Invite generation → publish completion rate	> 70%	> 80%
Product quality	App store rating	> 4.2 / 5.0	> 4.5 / 5.0

10.3 The Founding Story

From the founder

I built Hum Bawaal — an Indian Gen Z streetwear brand — because I believed that small Indian brands deserved the kind of presence that only large ones could afford. I apply the same logic to JALSA. Indian Gen Z deserves an event experience that understands who we actually are: the natural Hinglish, the collision of traditional celebration and global aesthetic, the RSVP that culturally never means anything, the WhatsApp group that always becomes unmanageable at exactly the wrong moment. Partiful solved this for Americans. JALSA solves it for us — built by us, for us, in a way that a company based in New York never truly could. I am not building the Indian version of something. I am building the version that should have existed first.

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